

# Alert design: what deserves a page

A page wakes a human. The bar is not whether the alert is true. The bar is whether it is worth someone's night.

# Three destinations, and only one wakes anyone

Every alert lands in one of three places. Most of the pain is landing wrong.

|              | PAGE                                                     | TICKET                                                | DASHBOARD                                              |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| PURPOSE      | Something is breaking now and only a person can stop it. | Real work that survives until the next working day.   | Context you read when you are already investigating.   |
| FAILURE MODE | A page that could have waited teaches people to wait.    | Something urgent filed here is read after the outage. | A dashboard notifies nobody. At 3am it is a dark room. |

# The test an alert must pass to earn a page

Three questions. A no to any one of them means this is not a page.



**All three, or it is not a page. Two out of three is still someone's night.**

# What to do with the alerts that fail

A failing alert is not left alone. It is deleted, downgraded, or fixed.

|                           |                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> <b>DELETE</b>    | It has never once changed what anyone did. Deleting it removes noise and nothing else; the check that produced it can stay.           |
| <b>B</b> <b>DOWNGRADE</b> | The condition is real and it can wait. Move it to a queue with a named owner and a date. A promise is not the same as silence.        |
| <b>C</b> <b>FIX</b>       | It fires because the system needs a human to survive. Repair the system and the alert deletes itself. Only this one lowers the count. |

# What we need to decide

The rule is short. Holding to it is not. These are the parts still open.

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**If it can wait, it is a ticket. If no one is needed, it is a script. If nobody is looking, it is a dashboard. What is left is a page.**

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**1** Who may delete an alert, and what do they have to show to do it?

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**2** How many pages in one shift is too many, and who makes that call?

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**3** Which alerts do we fix at the source before the next rotation?

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